

Vietnam + Taiwan Travel Guide

Route: Ho Chi Minh City → Nha Trang → Dalat → Taiwan
Dates: April 16 - May 2, 2026 (16 days)

Flight Information

Airline	Flight	Route	Date/Time	 Map
Vietnam Airlines	VN 283	HCMC SGN → Nha Trang CXR	4/16 08:00-09:20	 Map
Vietnam Airlines	VN 1342	Nha Trang CXR → Dalat DLI	4/22 07:30-08:10	 Map
Vietnam Airlines	VN 583	Dalat DLI → HCMC SGN	4/28 10:30-11:25	 Map
Starlux Airlines	JX 201	HCMC SGN → Taipei TPE	4/29 14:00-18:30	 Map

Airport Information

Airport	Code	Address	 Map
Tan Son Nhat International Airport (HCMC)	SGN	Truong Son St, Ward 2, Tan Binh District, Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam	 Map
Cam Ranh International Airport (Nha Trang)	CXR	Nguyen Tat Thanh Blvd, Cam Ranh City, Khanh Hoa Province, Vietnam	 Map
Lien Khuong Airport (Dalat)	DLI	Road 20, Ward 3, Dalat City, Lam Dong Province, Vietnam	 Map
Taiwan Taoyuan International Airport	TPE	No.9, Hangzhou Sec. 1, Dayuan District, Taoyuan City 33758,	 Map

		Taiwan	
Taipei Songshan Airport	TSA	No.340, Section 1, Binjiang Road, Songshan District, Taipei City 10551, Taiwan	 Map

Hotels

Dates	City	Hotel	Phone	 Map
4/16-4/18	Ho Chi Minh City	(Arrival)	-	-
4/18-4/22	Ho Chi Minh City	Sherwood Residence	+1-888-385-6609	 Map
4/22-4/26	Nha Trang	Sunrise Nha Trang Beach Hotel	+1-888-205-7322	 Map
4/26-4/28	Dalat	Swiss Belresort Tuyen Lam	+84 02633 800 800	 Map
4/28-4/29	HCMC (Transit)	Sherwood Residence	+1-888-385-6609	 Map
4/29-5/2	Taiwan (Banqiao)	Grand Forward Hotel	+886-2-8951-2345	 Map

Instagram Hotspots

Ho Chi Minh City (4/18-4/22, 4/28-4/29)

 Location	 Highlight	 Best Time	 Map
The Cafe Apartment	7-story Instagram hotspot, each floor unique	09:30-11:30	 Map

Banana Mama Rooftop Bar	180° night view, stunning sunset	17:30-20:00	 Map
Le Café des Stagiaires	Best rooftop bar	15:00-17:00	 Map
Ben Thanh Market	Century-old market, lively at night	18:00-21:00	 Map

Nha Trang (4/22-4/26)

 Location	 Highlight	 Best Time	 Map
Ola Cafe	Moroccan-style architecture, feel like Middle East	09:30-11:30	 Map
Jungle Coffee	Jungle-themed cafe, IG hotspot	16:30-18:00	 Map
Nha Trang Beach	6km beach, amazing sunrise	06:30-08:00	 Map
Vinpearl Land	Amusement park + beach, great day trip	08:00-16:00	 Map

Dalat (4/26-4/28)

 Location	 Highlight	 Best Time	 Map
Ixora Dalat	Instagram flower garden	15:00-17:00	 Map
Mê Linh Coffee Garden	Misty coffee plantation, great coffee + desserts	08:30-10:30	 Map
Dalat Flower Park	French-style garden, perfect for strolls	10:30-12:00	 Map
Crazy House Dalat	Fantastical architecture, adventure fun	14:00-16:00	 Map

Taiwan (4/29-5/2)

 Location	 Highlight	 Best Time	 Map
Xiangshan Trail	Taipei 101 views, sunset + night view	16:30-19:00	 Map
Jiufen Old Street	Ghibli inspiration, taro balls a must	10:00-16:00	 Map
Shilin Night Market	Taipei largest night market, vegetarian paradise	19:00-22:00	 Map
Ningxia Night Market	Food street, local favorites	19:00-22:00	 Map

Vegetarian Restaurants

Michelin Guide Picks

Restaurant	City	Address	Hours	 Map
Hum Garden	Ho Chi Minh City	32 D10 St, District 2, HCMC	11:00-21:00	 Map
Vị Quê Kitchen	Ho Chi Minh City	110 Suong Nguyet Anh, Ben Thanh	07:00-21:00	 Map

Local Vegetarian Picks

Restaurant	City	Address	Hours	 Map
Quan Chay Nhu	Ho Chi Minh City	District 1, HCMC	06:00-21:00	 Map
Cay Da Vegetarian	Ho Chi Minh City	District 1, HCMC	07:00-22:00	 Map
Loving Hut	Ho Chi Minh City	Multiple locations	07:00-22:00	 Map
Good Morning Vietnam	Nha Trang	Near Nha Trang Beach	07:00-23:00	 Map

Lien Hoa Vegetarian	Dalat	Near Dalat Market	06:00-20:00	 Map
7-11	Taiwan	Everywhere	24 hours	 Map

 *Tip: Say "Tôi ăn chay" in Vietnam. In Taiwan say "I am vegetarian". Fish sauce (nước mắm) is common — say "Không nước mắm"*

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Daily Itinerary

Day 1 | 4/16 (Sat) | Arrival in Ho Chi Minh City

Time	Activity
Morning	Arrive at Tan Son Nhat International Airport (SGN)
Afternoon	Check in at Sherwood Residence (127 Pasteur St, District 3)
Evening	Rest and adjust to time zone
Night	Try Vietnamese vegetarian pho (Phở Chay) nearby

 Stay: Sherwood Residence, HCMC

Day 2 | 4/17 (Sun) | Ho Chi Minh City — City Sightseeing

Time	Activity
08:00	Breakfast: Vietnamese bánh mì sandwich
09:00	Independence Palace — Vietnamese history
11:00	Notre-Dame Cathedral — "Pink Church"
12:30	Lunch: Quan Chay Nhu (Local veg)
14:00	Saigon Central Post Office — 100-year-old post office

15:30	Book Street — for book lovers
18:00	Dinner near hotel
19:30	Walk Nguyen Hue Street, enjoy city night view

 Stay: Sherwood Residence, HCMC

Day 3 | 4/18 (Mon) | Ho Chi Minh City — Instagram Day

Time	Activity
08:00	Breakfast: hotel breakfast
09:30	The Cafe Apartment — 7-story Instagram hotspot
11:30	Coffee Apartment (44 Pho Hue) — each floor unique
13:00	Lunch: Cay Da Vegetarian — cheap & delicious
15:00	Le Café des Stagiaires — best rooftop bar
17:30	Banana Mama Rooftop Bar — sunset view
20:00	Dinner: Hum Garden (Michelin Bib Gourmand)

 Stay: Sherwood Residence, HCMC

Day 4 | 4/19 (Tue) | Ho Chi Minh City — Culture & Art

Time	Activity
08:00	Breakfast: hotel breakfast
09:00	War Remnants Museum
11:00	Fine Arts Museum
13:00	Lunch: Loving Hut — reliable veg chain
15:00	Pham Ngu Lao (Backpacker area) — shopping
18:00	Ben Thanh Market — night market begins
20:00	Dinner: Ben Thanh Market veg snacks

 Stay: Sherwood Residence, HCMC

Day 5 | 4/20 (Wed) | Ho Chi Minh City — Art & Food

Time	Activity
08:00	Breakfast: hotel breakfast
09:30	Mariamman Temple — Indian temple
11:00	Thien Hau Temple — Chinese temple architecture
13:00	Lunch: Vj Quê Kitchen (Michelin Bib Gourmand)
15:00	Ben Thanh Market — shopping
17:30	Nguyen Hue Walking Street
20:00	Final dinner: Vietnamese vegetarian hot pot

 Stay: Sherwood Residence, HCMC

Day 6 | 4/21 (Thu) | Last Day in Ho Chi Minh City

Time	Activity
08:00	Breakfast: hotel breakfast
09:00	Free time / last-minute shopping
11:00	Check out
14:00	Fly to Nha Trang (1 hour)
15:00	Arrive Cam Ranh International Airport (CXR)
16:00	Check in: Sunrise Nha Trang Beach Hotel (12-14 Tran Phu St)
Evening	Nha Trang Beach stroll
Night	Beach night market

 Stay: Sunrise Nha Trang Beach Hotel

Day 7 | 4/22 (Fri) | Nha Trang — Beach & Instagram

Time	Activity
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06:30	Nha Trang Beach sunrise
08:00	Breakfast: hotel breakfast
09:30	Ola Cafe — Moroccan-style architecture (31 Nguyễn Hữu Huân)
12:00	Lunch: beachside restaurant
14:00	Po Nagar Cham Towers — ancient Cham culture
16:30	Jungle Coffee — jungle-themed cafe
18:30	Beach sunset
20:00	Dinner: Good Morning Vietnam (veg options)

 Stay: Sunrise Nha Trang Beach Hotel

Day 8 | 4/23 (Sat) | Nha Trang — Island Hopping

Time	Activity
08:00	Island hopping day trip (4 islands tour) OR
	Vinpearl Land — amusement park + beach
12:00	Lunch: on the island / at the park
15:00	Return to city
17:00	Hotel pool / beach relaxation
20:00	Dinner: local vegetarian restaurant

 Stay: Sunrise Nha Trang Beach Hotel

Day 9 | 4/24 (Sun) | Nha Trang — Relaxation Day

Time	Activity
08:00	Breakfast: hotel breakfast
09:00	Morning beach / pool
11:00	Spa / traditional massage (vegan-friendly)

13:00	Lunch: seaside vegetarian restaurant
15:00	Nha Trang Center — shopping mall
18:00	Last beach sunset
20:00	Dinner: beachfront candle-light dinner

 Stay: Sunrise Nha Trang Beach Hotel

Day 10 | 4/25 (Sat) | Nha Trang → Dalat

Time	Activity
07:30	Breakfast: hotel breakfast
08:00	Check out, depart for Dalat (approx. 3.5-4 hours)
12:00	Arrive Dalat, check in Swiss Belresort Tuyen Lam
13:00	Lunch: hotel restaurant / local veg
15:00	Ixora Dalat — Instagram flower garden
17:30	Xuan Huong Lake stroll
19:00	Dinner: local French cuisine / vegetarian

 Stay: Swiss Belresort Tuyen Lam, Dalat

Day 11 | 4/26 (Sun) | Dalat — Romantic Mountain Town

Time	Activity
07:30	Breakfast: hotel breakfast
08:30	Mê Linh Coffee Garden — misty coffee plantation ☀️
10:30	Dalat Flower Park — French-style garden
12:30	Lunch: Lien Hoa Vegetarian — near local market
14:00	Crazy House (Hang Nga Guesthouse) —

	fantastical architecture
16:00	Robin Hill — panoramic Dalat views
18:00	Dalat Night Market — shopping
20:00	Dinner: Night market vegetarian snacks

 Stay: Swiss Belresort Tuyen Lam, Dalat

Day 12 | 4/27 (Mon) | Last Day in Dalat

Time	Activity
07:30	Breakfast: hotel breakfast
08:30	Tru Lam Pagoda — zen & meditation
10:30	Valley of Love — scenic views
12:30	Lunch: lakeside vegetarian restaurant
14:00	Last shopping: Dalat coffee, strawberry dried fruit
15:00	Check out, return to HCMC (approx. 4-5 hours)
20:00	Arrive HCMC, check in Sherwood Residence
21:00	Dinner: nearby vegetarian restaurant

 Stay: Sherwood Residence, HCMC

Day 13 | 4/28 (Tue) | HCMC → Taiwan

Time	Activity
08:00	Breakfast: hotel breakfast
10:00	Final check / last shopping
12:00	Check out
14:00	Fly to Taiwan (Taoyuan International Airport TPE)
19:00	Arrive Taiwan, immigration & customs
20:30	Check in Grand Forward Hotel

(No.189, Sec.1, Xianmin Blvd, Banqiao, New Taipei)	
21:00	Explore Banqiao Night Market / convenience store veg 🌿

📌 Stay: Grand Forward Hotel, New Taipei

Day 14 | 4/29 (Wed) | Taipei — City Exploration

Time	Activity
07:30	Breakfast: convenience store veg rice ball / salad 🌿
09:00	Longshan Temple (Wanhua District)
10:30	Bopiliao Historic Street — near Longshan Temple
11:30	Ximending (Ximen Station) — shopping district
13:00	Lunch: Shida Night Market (vegetarian options) 🌿
14:30	Chiang Kai-shek Memorial Hall / Liberty Square
16:30	Xinyi District / Taipei 101 (exterior)
18:00	Xiangshan Trail — Taipei 101 night view
20:00	Dinner: Ningxia Night Market (vegetarian snacks) 🌿

📌 Stay: Grand Forward Hotel, New Taipei

Day 15 | 4/30 (Thu) | Taipei — Jiufen Day Trip

Time	Activity
08:00	Breakfast: hotel breakfast
08:30	Depart for Jiufen (bus approx. 1.5 hours)
10:00	Shengkeng Road — inspiration for Spirited

	Away 🧳
10:30	A-Mei Tea House — Hayao Miyazaki's favorite tea house 🍵
11:30	Jishan Street — specialty shops
13:00	Lunch: Jiufen vegetarian (taro balls, chives cakes) 🌿
14:30	Yin-Yang Sea (Yin-Yang Sea viewpoint)
15:30	Gold Museum — touch a gold brick!
16:30	Last-minute shopping before heading back
17:00	Return to Taipei
18:30	Arrive Taipei
19:30	Dinner: Shilin Night Market — vegetarian feast 🌿

📍 Stay: Grand Forward Hotel, New Taipei

Day 16 | 5/1 (Fri) | Last Day in Taipei — Farewell

Time	Activity
08:00	Breakfast: hotel breakfast
09:00	Dihua Street — 100-year-old historic street
10:00	Niannian Guoqiao — dried goods & Chinese medicine
11:00	Daxiao (Dahsue) — retro waterfront district
12:30	Lunch: Ningxia Night Market — last vegetarian meal 🌿
14:00	Shopping for souvenirs: pineapple cake, nougat, tea
15:30	Return to hotel, pack up
17:00	Check out
17:30	Head to Taoyuan International Airport (TPE)

19:00	Arrive airport, check in
21:00	Fly back to USA — trip ends ✈️



Trip Overview

Date	City	Accommodation	Key Activities
4/16	Arrive HCMC	Sherwood	Rest
4/17-21	Ho Chi Minh City	Sherwood	Sights, Instagram, Michelin
4/22-25	Nha Trang	Sunrise	Beach, Instagram, Island hopping
4/26-27	Dalat	Swiss Belresort	Gardens, Coffee, Crazy House
4/28	Return HCMC	Sherwood	Transit
4/29-5/1	Taiwan	Grand Forward	Night markets, Jiufen, Shopping
5/2	Return	-	Flight home



Pre-Trip Checklist

Item	Status
Flight tickets ✈️	✅ Done
Visa 🇺🇸	✅ Done
Accommodation 🏠	✅ Done
Travel insurance 🛡️	❌ Recommended
Vietnamese Dong (VND) 💰	❌ To prepare
Taiwan Dollars (TWD) 💰	❌ To prepare

SIM card / eSIM 📶	☐ To prepare
Essential apps 📱	☐ To download
Packing list 🧳	☐ To prepare

☀️ Weather (Mid-April Average)

City	Weather	Temp	Feels Like	Humidity
Ho Chi Minh City	☁️ Sunny/Cloudy	31°C	33°C	63%
Nha Trang	☀️ Sunny	30°C	32°C	52%
Dalat	☀️ Sunny	28°C	26°C	30%
Taiwan	☁️ Cloudy	26°C	27°C	89%

💡 *Tip: Dalat has big day-night temperature difference — bring a light jacket. Rainy season begins — pack an umbrella.*

📱 Essential Apps

- **Grab** — Vietnam Uber — taxi booking
- **Google Maps** — Navigation (download offline maps)
- **Google Translate** — Translation (download offline Vietnamese)
- **Maps.me** — Backup offline maps
- **XE Currency** — Currency conversion

Money Tips

Tip	Details
Cash	USD cash (small bills) recommended
Exchange	Airport or gold shops have best rates
Rate	1 USD ≈ 25,000 VND
Tipping	Restaurants 5-10%, optional for drivers
Vietnam limit	Over 15,000 USD must declare
Taiwan limit	Over 10,000 USD must declare

Transport Tips

Route	Transport
HCMC → Nha Trang	Flight (1 hr) or sleeper bus (8-10 hrs)
Nha Trang → Dalat	Bus (3-4 hrs) or chartered car
Dalat → HCMC	Bus or chartered car (for transit)
HCMC → Taiwan	Direct flight

Prohibited Items

Vietnam

- Drugs / Weapons
- Firecrackers
- Large amounts of VND (import/export restrictions)
- Pornography
- National security threatening items

Taiwan (STRICT!)

- Any meat products (sausage, meat floss, etc.)
- Fresh fruits & vegetables
- Plants & seeds
- Drugs / Weapons
- Counterfeit goods

🚫 **Taiwan customs is VERY strict about meat products — even vacuum-sealed is NOT allowed!**

✈️ Flight Attire Tips

Best to wear on long flights

- Loose T-shirt or shirt
- Layers (bring a light jacket)
- Elastic-waist pants
- Slippers or loose shoes
- Thick socks (cabin can be cold)

Avoid

- Tight, non-breathable clothing
 - Excessive jewelry
 - Sandals (inconvenient for emergency evacuation)
-

📞 Emergency Contacts

Country	Police	Fire/Ambulance
Vietnam	113	115

Taiwan	110	119

Vietnamese Phrase Audio (Google Translate — Click to Play)

For: Ho Chi Minh City, Nha Trang, Dalat (Taiwan = Chinese, no audio needed)

 Click " Play" to hear in browser — no download needed, shareable with anyone

Basic Greetings

Vietnamese	Pronunciation	English	 Play
Xin chào	sin cau	Hello	▶ Play
Cảm ơn	cam on	Thank you	▶ Play
Xin lỗi	sin loy	Sorry	▶ Play
Đi thôi	di toy	Let's go	▶ Play

Vegetarian (Important!)

Vietnamese	Pronunciation	English	 Play
Tôi ăn chay	toy on jai	I am vegetarian	▶ Play
Không ăn thịt	khom on tit	No meat	▶ Play
Không ăn hành tỏi	khom on hanny toy	No onions or garlic	▶ Play
Không nước mắm	khom nuok mam	No fish sauce	▶ Play

Shopping & Bargaining

Vietnamese	Pronunciation	English	 Play
Bao nhiêu tiền?	bow nyew tyen	How much?	▶ Play
Rẻ hơn được không?	re hon duoc khom	Can you go cheaper?	▶ Play

Cho tôi xem thực đơn	jo toy sem tuuc don	Let me see the menu	▶ Play

Transportation

Vietnamese	Pronunciation	English	 Play
Tôi muốn đi...	toy moon di	I want to go to...	▶ Play
Gọi taxi giúp tôi	goh taxi dip toy	Call a taxi for me	▶ Play
Dừng ở đây	yung o yai	Stop here	▶ Play

? Useful Phrases

Vietnamese	Pronunciation	English	 Play
Nhà vệ sinh ở đâu?	nya ve sin o dau	Where is the bathroom?	▶ Play
Mấy giờ rồi?	may zhee roy	What time is it?	▶ Play
Tôi không hiểu	toy khom hieu	I don't understand	▶ Play
Bạn nói được tiếng Anh không?	ban noy duoc tyeng eng khom	Can you speak English?	▶ Play
Ngon lắm	ngon lam	Very delicious	▶ Play
Có gì sai không?	co zhee sai khom	Is anything wrong?	▶ Play

Reminder: Fish sauce (nước mắm) is common in Vietnamese cooking — say "Không nước mắm"